

Matthew Beardwell

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Professional Summary

Security Analyst with strengths in digital forensics and OSINT. Experience includes ARM instruction patching and binary analysis. Recovered deleted data and artefacts in both lab-based and real-world contexts. Completed 116 hands-on labs (~100 hrs, Top 2% TryHackMe) and earned a First-Class BSc in Computer Science from King's College London. Currently preparing for CompTIA Security+.

Technical Skills

- **Scripting and Programming:** Python, Bash, PowerShell, C, ARM Assembly
- **Networking:** Wireshark, TCP/IP analysis, PCAP inspection
- **Forensics:** Autopsy, dd, foremost, photorec, scalpel; disk image recovery and file carving
- **OSINT:** Identity/location tracing, metadata correlation, client investigations, toolkit authoring
- **Reverse Engineering:** GDB, IDA Free, Ghidra, radare2, ARM runtime patching

Cybersecurity Projects

- ActiveReconLite** · *Python Port Scanner* FEB 2025 – MAR 2025
Built a Python-based TCP connect port scanner using multiprocessing. Outperforms Nmap in some cases by 60x; scanned 65k ports in 5s (vs Nmap's 5m). It validates user input, grabs banners, and writes results to a file. Demonstrates automation, socket programming, and parallel scanning. github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite
- Location and Identity Resolution from Minimal Public Signals** · *OSINT Case Study* APR 2025
Tracked real-world identity from anonymised YouTube uploads using public data. Shows attacker thinking, threat profiling, and privacy risk awareness. Demonstrates threat intelligence process fundamentals: collection, enrichment, analysis, and attribution based on minimal public indicators. github.com/mbeardwell/osint-i3-case-study
- UK Person-centric OSINT Toolkit** JUN 2025
Curation of UK-only, legal person-focused OSINT resources for investigative use. Supports human profiling, exposure tracking, and background validation tasks. github.com/mbeardwell/uk-personal-osint-toolkit
- Faster Dynamically Instrumented Programs** · *Bachelor's Thesis* OCT 2022 – MAY 2023
Built a runtime patching tool on ARM Linux to redirect processor instructions in memory. Mirrors techniques used in evasive malware. github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu

Professional Experience

- Building expertise during ongoing health recovery. Not currently available for roles. Open to future opportunities.*
- Security Training and Labs** · *TryHackMe (Self-Led Learning)* FEB 2022 – PRESENT
Completed 116 hands-on labs (~100 hrs) that included digital forensics, OSINT, and reverse engineering. Ranked in the Top 2% globally.
- Freelance OSINT Investigations** · *Client-Based & Self-Led* 2024 – 2025
Conducted multiple open-ended OSINT investigations, including one extensively documented client case and several self-led identity/location tracing projects.
- Private Tutor** · *Freelance* SEP 2016 – NOV 2019
Supported children with pre-GCSE homework, primarily in maths; adapted explanations to varying ability levels in informal settings.
- Research and Documentation Intern** · *Indo UK Institute of Health* JUN 2017 – AUG 2017
Conducted market research on employee benefits and strategic partnerships, providing executives with key insights. Edited and reformatted high-level strategic documents that shaped discussions on a billion-pound health-care initiative.

Education and Certifications

BSc (Hons) CS · King's College London	First-Class	SEP 2018 – JUL 2023
A-Levels · King's Maths School	A* A* A* A*	SEP 2016 – JUL 2018
Certifications		
CompTIA	Security+	(IN PROGRESS)
TryHackMe	Intro to Cyber Security	FEB 2024
Security Blue Team	Intro to OSINT	JUN 2025
TryHackMe	Pre-Security	APR 2022
Prince's Trust	TEAM (12-week programme incl. First Aid)	JAN 2024 – APR 2024